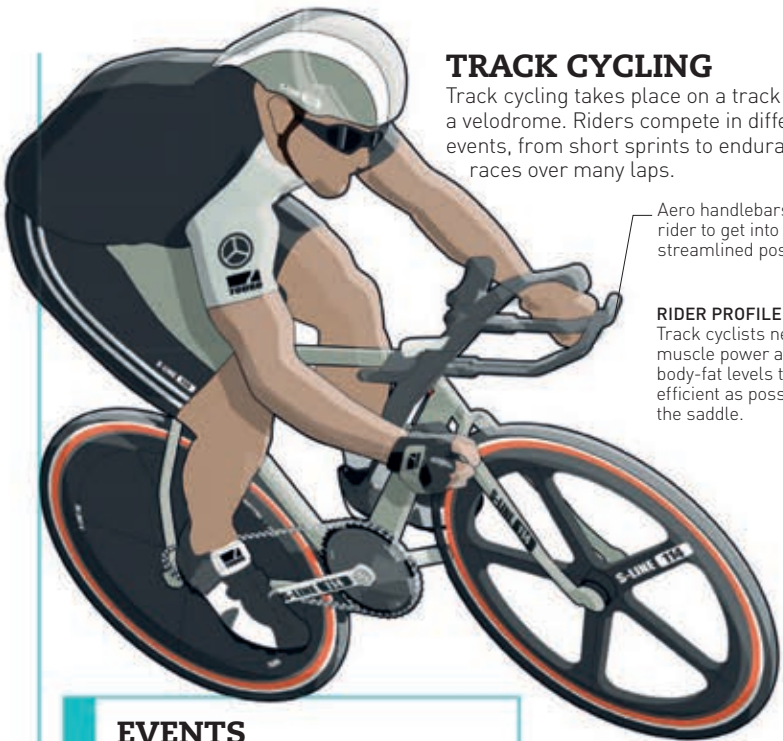




TRACK CYCLING

Track cycling takes place on a track called a velodrome. Riders compete in different events, from short sprints to endurance races over many laps.

Aero handlebars allow rider to get into a streamlined position

RIDER PROFILE

Track cyclists need high muscle power and low body-fat levels to be as efficient as possible in the saddle.

EVENTS

There are ten Olympic track cycling events, with men and women competing in each of the five events listed.

- **INDIVIDUAL SPRINT**
Two riders race over three laps of the track.
- **TEAM SPRINT**
Two teams of three riders race over three laps.
- **TEAM PURSUIT**
Two teams of four riders race over 4 km (2.5 miles). Teams start on opposite sides of the track.
- **KEIRIN**
Cyclists ride several laps behind a motorcycle pacemaker before sprinting to the finish.
- **OMNIUM**
Twenty-four riders contest six different events: three sprints and three endurance races. The strongest overall rider wins.

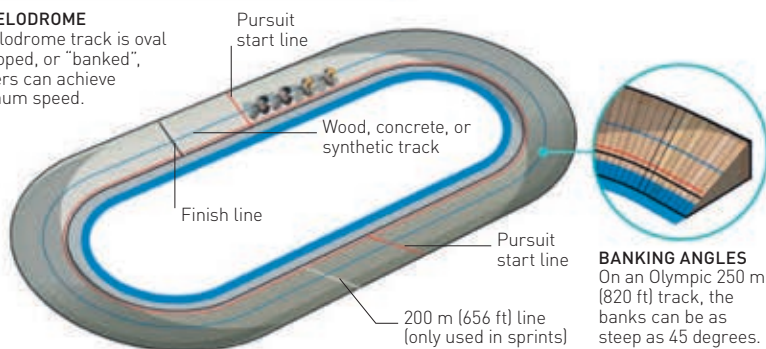


MADISON

The Madison is a relay event for teams of two. When the riders change over, one uses his hand to propel the other into the race.

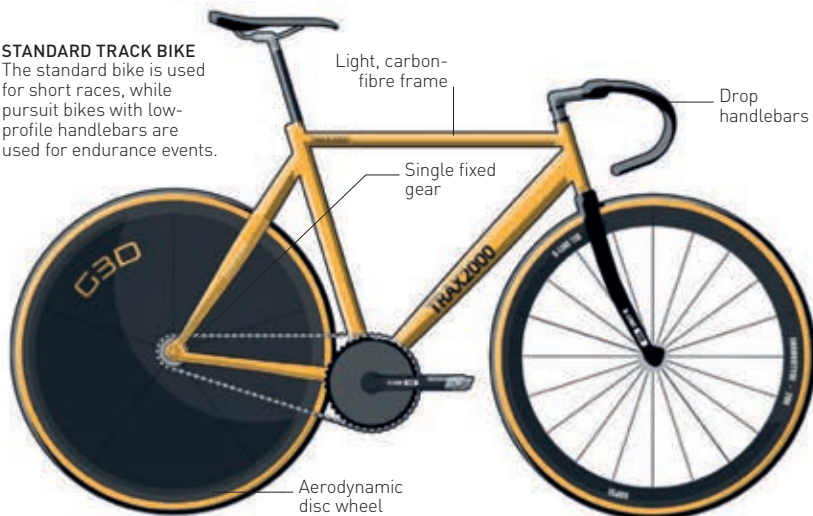
THE VELODROME

The velodrome track is oval and sloped, or "banked", so riders can achieve maximum speed.



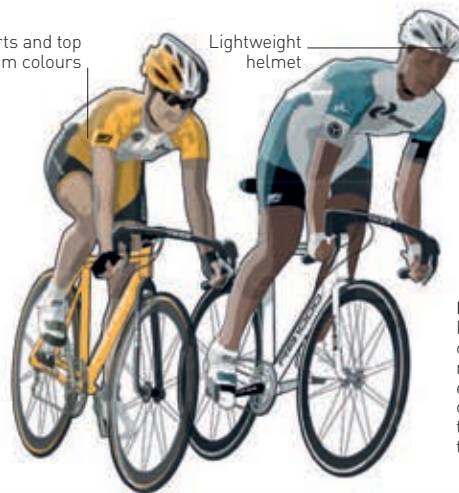
STANDARD TRACK BIKE

The standard bike is used for short races, while pursuit bikes with low-profile handlebars are used for endurance events.



Shorts and top in team colours

Lightweight helmet



ROAD RACING

Road racing is one of the most physically demanding of all sports. Multi-stage races can cover thousands of kilometres in a few weeks and include all-day mountain climbs and 80 km/h (50 mph) sprints.

RIDER PROFILE

Road racers have an enormous capacity for physical and mental endurance. They must eat a balanced diet with a lot of carbohydrates – riders eat up to 6,000 calories on race days to maintain energy levels.

TOUR DE FRANCE

The Tour is the world's most famous road race. Riders cover about 3,500 km (2,175 miles) in 21 stages, finishing in Paris.



POLKA DOT JERSEY
Awarded to the King of the Mountains, the best climber.



WHITE JERSEY
Worn by the highest-placed young rider.



GREEN JERSEY
Awarded to the best sprinter.



YELLOW JERSEY
Worn by the overall leader.

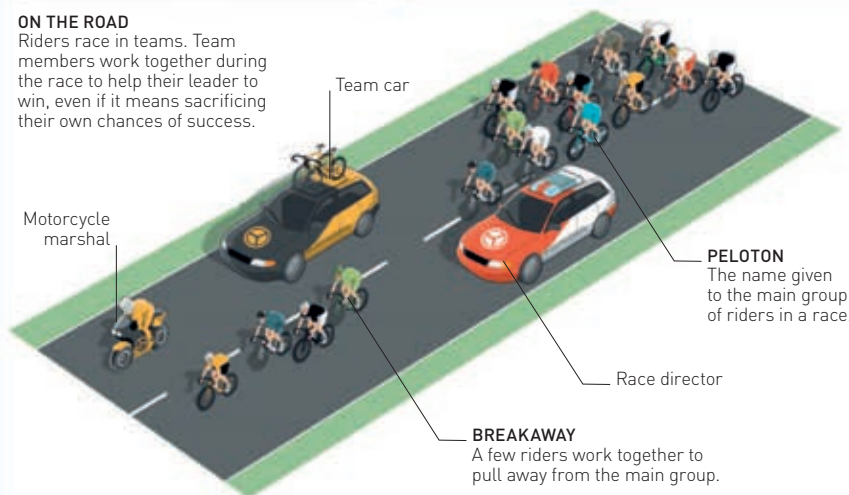
RACE FORMATS

Road race formats range from one-day races to multi-stage endurance events. There are two Olympic events, the classic road race and the individual time trial.

- **STAGE RACE**
A race over several stages in which the winner is the rider whose combined time is the quickest. May include sprint stages, mountain finishes, and individual or team time-trials.
- **CLASSIC**
One-day races of up to 270 km (168 miles), often ridden over difficult terrain, such as cobbled roads.
- **INDIVIDUAL TIME TRIAL**
Competitors race individually against the clock.
- **CRITERIUM**
A high-speed race, on a city-centre circuit of less than 5 km (3 miles), over a set time (usually one hour) or a fixed number of laps.

ON THE ROAD

Riders race in teams. Team members work together during the race to help their leader to win, even if it means sacrificing their own chances of success.



ROAD BIKE

Road bikes have to be strong, light, and comfortable enough to be ridden for long periods.

